

01 SMALL TALK

What's one app you open almost every day?

How was your weekend — busy or relaxing?

Are you more of a phone person or a laptop person these days?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

① ~~"I want to upgrade my English skill."~~

✓ "I want to improve my English. / I want to level up my English."

'upgrade'는 기기나 소프트웨어에 써요. 실력은 improve나 level up이 자연스러워요.

② ~~"I will challenge English this year."~~

✓ "I'll take on English this year. / I'll give English a real try."

'challenge'를 '도전하다'로 직역하면 어색해요. 영어에선 보통 '의의를 제기하다' 뜻이에요.

③ ~~"I studied English hardly."~~

✓ "I studied English hard."

'hardly'는 '거의 ~않다'라서 정반대 뜻이에요. '열심히'는 그냥 hard예요.

03 오늘의 워업

각자 "내 영어 실력에 진짜 도움 되는 순서"로 1-4위 매기고 1위만 말하기. 다른 사람 의견 들으며 자기 순위 한 번 더 정리.

WARM-UP

Rank Them (5분)

1. Using a learning app every day
2. Talking with people in English
3. Watching shows or videos in English
4. Taking a class with a teacher

English Learning Apps — Real Progress or Short Trend?

BACKGROUND

영어 학습 앱은 시작하기 쉽고 매일 기록이 남아서 동기부여가 되지만, 진짜 실력으로 이어지는지는 사용 방식에 따라 달라요. 앱을 켜는 것 자체가 공부처럼 느껴져도 실제로 말하고 듣고 문장을 써보지 않으면 변화가 작을 수 있어요. 반대로 짧은 앱 루틴이 수업이나 실제 대화와 연결되면 꾸준함을 만드는 도구가 될 수 있죠. 앱은 목표가 아니라 습관을 돕는 장치에 가까워요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

English learning apps are easy to start because they feel light, measurable, and available anytime. Streaks, scores, reminders, and short lessons can help learners come back every day. But opening an app is not the same as improving. Real progress usually needs active speaking, listening, writing, correction, and using the language outside the app. An app can become a short trend if the learner only collects points. It can become useful if it supports a bigger routine: reviewing phrases before class, practicing pronunciation, or getting ready for real conversations. The value depends on whether the app connects to real language use. Speaking improves when practice becomes regular enough to feel normal. The best method depends less on what sounds impressive and more on what keeps someone speaking after the first motivation fades.

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

it keeps me going — 계속하게 만든다

it feels like a chore — 숙제처럼 느껴진다

it gets old fast — 금방 질린다

on autopilot — 무의식적으로, 기계적으로

stick with it — 꾸준히 계속하다

half the battle — 절반은 한 셈

TRY THESE PHRASES

Looking back, the app that helped me most taught me __, so I'd say it was real progress.

Honestly, it felt like progress at first — but the real change came when __.

It depends on the day, but usually a streak makes me __ instead of giving up.

The thing is, scores can stress me out when __, so I try to __.

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'download-every-new-app' or a 'stick-to-one-app' kind of learner?
- 2 When was the last time you actually opened an English learning app — today, this week, or 'it's still on my phone somewhere'?
- 3 Quick — if you had to pick one thing to practice on an app: speaking out loud, listening, or new words?
- 4 What's your usual move when you've got ten free minutes on the bus — open a learning app, scroll social media, or just rest?

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. Have learning apps ever helped you make real progress, or did it just feel like progress?

Looking back, the app that helped me most taught me __, so I'd say it was real progress.

Honestly, it felt like progress at first — but the real change came when __.

Q2. Do daily streaks and scores keep you going, or do they stress you out?

It depends on the day, but usually a streak makes me __ instead of giving up.

The thing is, scores can stress me out when __, so I try to __.

Q3. When does using an app turn into just tapping buttons? What's your sign?

My sign is when I stop __ and just __ without thinking.

When I notice myself __, I know the app has turned into tapping buttons.

Q4. Would you use an app alone, or combine it with a class or real conversation? Why?

I'd say I'd combine them, because an app is good for __ but real conversation gives me __.

Compared to studying alone with an app, talking with a real person feels __.

Q5. What would make an app stay useful after the excitement fades?

It really comes down to whether the app connects to __ in my daily life.

What keeps it useful for me is __, even after the new feeling is gone.